

953 Speaking activity: class discussions

Assignment: you will prepare and moderate a discussion in the class on a topic of your choice.

- This is a **pair work** assignment -preparation and moderation should be shared equally by both persons.
- Discussion in class can take about **30-40min**.
- **Grades will be given individually.**

Until Sunday 23 November: DECIDE ON: YOUR TEAM AND TOPIC (write to Jelena on Teams)

Task steps:

1. W47 Decide who you want to work with. Make sure you choose somebody with whom you can work and co-ordinate the work easily.
2. W47 Topic: together **choose a topic** that you find **relevant** for your life, our society or/and our world in general, and **that will provide a basis for a good and interesting discussion in class**. It can preferably be linked to new technologies or the IT world. Pls do not recycle the topic of presentations you had in ABU. The teacher also needs to approve and give you an ok for your topic.
3. W47 **Post your topic and your names on Teams** in the document "Discussion topics" – make sure that nobody else has already posted the same or similar topic.
4. **W48 Distance learning task:**
 - **Create a planning document** (one page word document): describe your topic in detail, give arguments why it is relevant and why the class should be interested in discussing it, **describe your methodology (how will you organize the discussion in class, how will you two share the moderation)** and provide the links to the main resources you are going to use.
 - **Post your planning document on Teams** in the folder "Discussion planning documents" until given deadline (pls have **your topic plus your names in the document title**).
5. Prepare the discussion in pairs and **be ready on the assigned date**. Dates of discussions will be posted on Teams in the folder "Discussion schedule".

Dates and deadlines overview

- **W47 Decide on your topic and team (2 people) – post your names and topic in Teams.**
- **Distance learning task for W48: Create a planning document and post it in Teams (see details in Tasks steps above) until midnight on the day we have English lesson.**
- **Start of class discussion will be in January.**

Tips

- Do thorough research on the topic and stick to your plan.
- Introduce yourself briefly before the discussion.
- Start with a powerful opening and finish with a memorable ending.
- Be neutral – give the audience a chance to express their own views.
- Most important: **Engage the audience throughout the debate.**
- Give the word to different people and don't be afraid to cut long monologues off.
- Ensure tight time management.
- At the end, make sure to summarize the outcome of the discussion.